

View results

Respondent

37

Anonymous

122:23

Time to complete

A. General information about the respondent

1. * Country

Iran (Islamic Republic of)



2. * Name of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

1- National Research Institute for Science Policy (NRISP), (Ministry of Science, Research and Technology)

3. * Website of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

<https://en.nrisp.ac.ir/>

4. * Email address of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

5. Phone number of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

6. Please describe the role/mandate of your organization

As a research institute and policy think tank, the mandate of the NRISP is to

7. * Full name of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

Ms. Tahereh Miremadi

8. * Position of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

Designated focal point, Iran

9. * Email address of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

10. Full Name(s) of designated official(s) certifying the report

Mr. Hassan Fartousi, Director-General of the UNESCO, Iran.

11. Brief description of the consultation process established for the preparation of the report

A joint committee, encompassing representatives of the Iranian Research Organization for Science and Technology (IROST) and NRISP and Tarbiat Modares University, (TMU) made the necessary coordination and jointly fill the questionnaire out.

12. * Name of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey

The Iranian Research Organization of Science and Technology (IROST) and NRISP and Tarbiat Modares University,

13. * Website of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey
(Please use commas to separate multiple links, as: link A, link B)

irost.org, <https://modares.ac.ir>

14. * Email address of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey

15. Sector of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey



Public



Private



Civil Society



Other

B. QUESTIONNAIRE FOR MEMBER STATES' REPORTING

ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE 2021 RECOMMENDATION ON OPEN SCIENCE

Part 1. PROMOTING A COMMON UNDERSTANDING OF OPEN SCIENCE,

ASSOCIATED BENEFITS AND CHALLENGES, AS WELL AS DIVERSE PATHS TO OPEN
SCIENCE

16. 1.1 Has the 2021 UNESCO Recommendation on Open Science been promoted and/or shared with appropriate ministries and institutions as well as affiliated organizations in your country?

☒ Yes

☐ No

17. 1.1 cont. **If yes**, please indicate which ministries and or national authorities/entities have been involved in the promotion of the 2021 Recommendation.

Ministry of Science, Research and Technology, Iran, the National Commission of UNESCO, Iran

18. 1.2 Is the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science available in the national language(s) of your country?

☒ Yes

☐ No

19. 1.2 cont. **If yes**, which language(s)?

Persian

20. 1.3 Have there been awareness raising activities on open science, including all its key elements[i], associated benefits and challenges, organized or foreseen to be organized by the end of 2025 in your country by national authorities or entities? (ref.: (i) 16.f, 16.g, 16.h)

[i] Please refer to the elements of open science defined in the 2021 Recommendation, namely : open scientific knowledge (including open access to scientific publications, research data, open educational resources, open-source software and code, open hardware), open science infrastructures, open engagement of societal actors and open dialogue with other knowledge systems.

☒ Yes

☐ No

21. 1.3 cont. **If yes**, please provide details on the activities organized or foreseen and links as relevant.

Yes! a)-There was an event held by the Iranian Association for UN Studies. b)-Several linkedin posts contributed to creating vivid debate on the importance of "Open Science" and UNESCO initiatives in Iran. You can find the event and the whole debates in the link below:
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/tahereh-miremadi-1aaa8640/recent-activity/all/> c)-It is planned to hold a workshop on the Open Science-Open innovation in the Spring of 2025 at the Iranian Research Organization for Science and Technology (IROST).

22. 1.4 Have specific actions been undertaken or are planned to be undertaken by end of 2025 in your country to incorporate the values and principles of open science[i], in publicly funded research? (ref.: (i) 16.a, 16.b, 16.c, 16.d, 16.e, 16.h)

[i] The 2021 Recommendation outlines a set of shared values of open science stemming from the rights-based, ethical, epistemological, economic, legal, political, social, multi-stakeholder and technological implications of opening science to society and broadening the principles of openness to the whole cycle of scientific research. It also provides a set of guiding principles, as a framework for enabling conditions and practices, which uphold the values of open science and can realize the ideals of open science.

Please see the values of open science, namely quality and integrity, collective benefit, equity and fairness, and diversity and inclusiveness.

Please see the guiding principles for open science ,namely transparency, scrutiny, critique and reproducibility; equality of opportunities; responsibility, respect and accountability; collaboration, participation and inclusion; flexibility and sustainability.

☒ Yes

☐ No

23. 1.4 cont. If **yes**, please indicate the actions that are taken to incorporate the specific values and principles. For each case, please provide details and links as relevant.

1. A series of seminars and conferences are planned to be held in higher education institutions for this year and the precise information will be subsequently provided. 2. the book, UNESCO Open Science Outlook I: Statutes and Trends around the World 2023 has been translated and will be out in few mounth.

Part 2. DEVELOPING AN ENABLING POLICY ENVIRONMENT FOR OPEN SCIENCE

24. 2.1 Does your country have a national policy[i], strategy or plan of action on science, technology and innovation (STI)?

[i] National STI policy is most commonly a governmental document developed by governing bodies leading the STI policy design and implementation in a given country, which formulates objectives and guides actions and decision-making processes in the area of STI on the national level.

☒ Yes

☐ No

25. 2.1 cont. **If yes**

· please share a machine-readable PDF file of the policy using this link: <https://tinyurl.com/27p5zct8> designating openscience@unesco.org as the recipient, and provide the following information: *Title of the policy, the authority in charge of development of the policy, entities involved and the process of development, year of adoption, year of last update, key areas/sections of the policy, and links to the webpage if available.*

In the comment box, please indicate the question number for this attachment / document.

After uploading, please return to this page to continue the survey.

Yes! Since 1992, Iran has had the Five-Year Plan for Science and Technology and Development, as an essential part of the Third Five-Year Plan of Cultural, Socio- Economic Development of the Country, designed by the National Plan and Program Organization. Now, the Seventh STI plan is being implemented. See: <https://unctad.org/publication/science-technology-and-innovation-policy-review-iran>

26. 2.1 cont. **If yes:**

- does it include any of the following open science elements:

- ☐ open access to scientific knowledge
- ☐ open science infrastructure
- ☐ open engagement of societal actors
- ☐ open dialogue with other knowledge systems

27. 2.2 In your country, is there a policy, or a set of policies and/or legal framework(s)[i] at the national level that address open science or any of its key elements in line with the definition, values and principles outlined in the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science? (ref.: (i) 16.a, 16.b, 16.c, 16.d, 16.e, 16.h)

[i] These can include specific national policies, sets of guidelines, rules, regulations, laws, principles, or directions to govern open science practices.

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ Partly
- ☐ No

28. 2.2 cont. **If yes or partly**, please share a machine-readable PDF file(s) of the policy(ies) using this link: <https://tinyurl.com/27p5zct8> designating openscience@unesco.org as the recipient, and provide the following information for each: *Title of the policy or legal instrument, the authority in charge of development of the policy, entities involved and the process of development, year of adoption, year of last update, key areas/sections of the policy, elements of open science that are addressed, and links to the webpage(s) if available.*

Yes! The official policy for Iranian scientific journals, made by the Ministry of Science, Research and Technology and the Ministry of Health and Medical education includes "Open Access publishing." According to DOAJ website, the number of Iranian Scientific Journals free of charge are now 973. See: <https://shorturl.at/UxCX0> However, according to an administrative circular, signed by the Minister of Science, Research and Technology, all editors-in-chief of the Iranian scientific journals are allowed to require the authors of the accepted papers to pay some editorial fees. Nonetheless, the majority of the journal decline to receive any editorial fees from the authors, thus implementing in practice the diamond policy (payment not by author nor by reader).

29. 2.3 In your country, are there specific policy instruments[i] that aim to promote open science?

[i] Policy instruments include programmes, methods and mechanisms of technical and operational nature, required to solve the issues set by the policy, with focus on the target beneficiaries, resources, indicators, and set of goals for delivering products (short term), results (medium-term), and impacts (long term).

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ Under development
- ☐ No

30. 2.3 cont. **If yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant, including for each instrument: *Title of the instrument, its objective, the authority in charge, allocated budget, elements of open science included.*

Yes! The official policy for Iranian scientific journals, made by the Ministry of Science, Research and Technology and the Ministry of Health and Medical education includes "Open Access publishing." According to DOAJ website, the number of Iranian Scientific Journals free of charge are now 973. See: <https://shorturl.at/UxCX0> However, according to an administrative circular, signed by the Minister of Science, Research and Technology, all editors-in-chief of the Iranian scientific journals are allowed to require the authors of the accepted papers to pay some editorial fees. Nonetheless, the majority of the journal decline to receive any editorial fees from the authors, thus implementing in practice the diamond policy (payment not by author nor by reader).

31. 2.4 In your country, is there a national implementation plan, strategy, policy or a roadmap for implementation of open science at the national level in line with the 2021 Recommendation? (ref.: (ii) 17.a, 17.b, 17.c, 17.f, 17.h)

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ Under development
- ☐ No

32. 2.4 cont. **If yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant, including the name of ministries and national authorities/entities, as well as affiliated organizations that are involved in the development and implementation of the plan, strategy or the roadmap.

Ministry of Science, Research and Technology is in charge

33. 2.5 In your country, are there policies and/or strategies that promote open science in line with the 2021 Recommendation at **institutional** level, including in the context of research-performing institutions, universities, scientific unions and associations and learned societies? (ref.: (ii) 17.d, 17.e, 17.g)



Yes



Under development



No

34. 2.5 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information, including the number of policies, name of the institute(s) that has/have developed the policy(s) and elements of open science included in the policy (please consider policies and strategies addressing all elements of open science, including citizen and participatory science, or co-production of knowledge with multiple actors). To view the elements of open science, see: <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949/PDF/379949eng.pdf.multi.nameddest=20/p.nameddest=20/.page=9>

IROST, NRISP

35. 2.6 In your country, are there specific funding mechanisms[i] for open science at the national level? (ref.: (ii) 17.j, (iii) 18.j, (iv) 19.c)

[i] A funding mechanism refers to a policy instrument or process through which financial resources are allocated or provided for a specific purpose. Some examples are block funding, research grants, support for technological poles and centres of excellence, support for science parks and innovation centres, Infrastructure grants (for research facilities, labs, instruments), communication and outreach funds, innovation funds, loans and tax credits scholarships, studentships, fellowships, trust funds, sectoral funds.



Yes



Under development



No

36. 2.6 cont. **If yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant.

The government and private publishers are in charge of providing for scientific publications that are accessible free of charge for all audiences.

37. 2.7 1.1 In your country, have open science practices[i] been integrated in existing research funding mechanisms?

[i] Examples can include sharing open scientific knowledge (publications, research data, educational resources, software and hardware) with other scientists and with the public, sharing or using open infrastructures, collaboration with other researchers, with national and local societal actors such as policy makers, or sectors such as industry, agriculture, and health, and collaboration and open dialogue with indigenous peoples and local communities.

☒ Yes

☐ No

38. 2.7 cont. **If yes**, please provide details and links as relevant.

Articles in scientific publications are open to readers by default

39. 2.8 Have efforts been made or are foreseen to be undertaken by end of 2025 in your country to foster equitable public-private partnerships on open science in line with the 2021 Recommendation? (ref.: (ii) 17.i)

☐ Yes

☒ No

40. 2.8 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

this issue is currently being reviewed and a number of initiatives are being considered

41. 2.9 Is there a national monitoring framework for open science in your country? Or are there specific indicators on open science included in the national monitoring and evaluation framework for STI policy (ref.: (ii) 17.j, 23.c)

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Under development
- ☒ No

Part 3. INVESTING IN OPEN SCIENCE INFRASTRUCTURES AND SERVICES

42. 3.1 What is the latest official data for your country's percentage of national gross domestic product (GDP) dedicated to research and development expenditure? Please also indicate the year of publication of this data, and to which year(s) it refers. (ref.: (iii) 18.a)

The GERD of Iranian GDP amounts to 0.8 of GDP according to Global value index 2024.
<https://www.wipo.int/gii-ranking/en/iran-islamic-republic-of-/section/economy-profile>

43. 3.2 What is the latest official data for the percentage of your country's population that have access to reliable internet and bandwidth? Please also indicate the year of publication of this data, and to which year(s) it refers. (ref.: (iii) 18.b)

According to <https://datareportal.com>: There were 69.83 million internet users in Iran at the start of 2023, when internet penetration stood at 78.6 percent. • Iran was home to 48.00 million social media users in January 2023, equating to 54.0 percent of the total population. • A total of 126.9 million cellular mobile connections were active in Iran in early 2023, with this figure equivalent to 142.8 percent of the total population. See /reports/?tag=Digital+2023&utm_source=DataReportal&utm_medium=Country_Article_Hyperlink&utm_campaign=Digital_2023&utm_term=Iran&utm_content=Year_Collection_Tag_Link

44. 3.3 Are there national research and education networks (NRENs)[i] active in the country? (*ref.: (iii) 18.c*)

[i] A national research and education network (NREN) is a specialised internet service provider dedicated to supporting the needs of the research and education communities within a country.

☐ Yes

☒ No

45. 3.3 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to establish them.

No! There used to exist a national network of scientific data which stopped working. There is a plan to establish national research and education network, but there is no reliable information to report!

46. 3.4 Are there national or institutional open science infrastructures[i] in your country? (ref.: (iii) 18.d, 18.e, 18.k, 18.l, 18.m)

[i] Some examples of open science infrastructures include major shared scientific equipment or sets of instruments, open computational and data manipulation service infrastructures that enable collaborative and multidisciplinary data analysis, open science platforms and repositories for publications, research data and source codes, archives, open bibliometrics and scientometrics systems for assessing and analysing scientific domains, open laboratories, software forges and virtual research environments, open innovation testbeds, incubators, science museums, science parks and infrastructure for non-digital materials.



Yes



Under development



No

47. 3.4 cont. **If yes or under development**, please indicate which type(s) of infrastructure:



federated information technology infrastructure for open science, including high-performance computing, cloud computing and data storage



community managed infrastructures, protocols and standards, for example those that support bibliodiversity and engagement with society



platforms for exchanges and co-creation of knowledge between scientists and society



community-based monitoring and information systems to complement national, regional and global data and information systems

48. 3.4 cont. **If yes or under development**, for each infrastructure, please provide links as relevant and more information with regard to their compliance with the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science in terms of inclusivity, accessibility, interoperability, community governance, FAIR (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable) and CARE (Collective Benefit, Authority to Control, Responsibility and Ethics) principles. Please indicate if the infrastructure is non-commercial.

Yes! There are several centralized platforms to host open access version of scientific papers like Elmnet.ir. <https://elmnet.ir/> and <https://www.sid.ir/>

49. 3.5 Does your country host or fund any federated regional or international information technology infrastructure for open science? (ref.: (iii) 18.e, 18.f)

☐ Yes

☒ No

50. 3.5. cont. **If no**, are the existing open science infrastructures at regional and international levels accessible to all the relevant open science actors from your country?

☒ Yes

☐ No

☒ Concerning the physical infrastructure, there are few possibilities for researchers in different t

51. 3.6 Is your country involved in any North-South, North-South-South and South-South collaborations to optimize infrastructure use and joint strategies for shared, multinational, regional and national open science platforms? (ref.: (iii) 18.g)

☐ Yes

☒ No

Part 4. INVESTING IN HUMAN RESOURCES, TRAINING, EDUCATION, DIGITAL LITERACY

AND CAPACITY BUILDING FOR OPEN SCIENCE

52. 4.1 Has systematic capacity building on open science taken place in higher education and/or research performing institutions in your country? (ref.: (iv) 19.a, 19.c)

☒ Yes

☐ No

53. 4.1 cont. **If yes**, please indicate if those capacity building initiatives are formal or informal and provide more information and links as relevant.

The answer is partly yes. Since some of the core value and principles of open science programs are quite common in the Iranian culture of S&T governance. For example, In 2007, the majority of students (60%) enrolled in Iranian universities were women according to Payvand and the percentage of women in higher education has increased nearly 21 times since the Islamic Revolution -which exhibits the key value of equity, fairness and inclusiveness.

54. 4.2 Have capacity building programmes for policy makers on how to integrate core values and principles of open science in STI policies and strategies taken place in your country?

☒ Yes

☐ No

55. 4.2 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant.

The answer is partly yes. Since some of the core value and principles of open science programs are quite common in the Iranian culture of S&T governance. For example, In 2007, the majority of students (60%) enrolled in Iranian universities were women according to Payvand and the percentage of women in higher education has increased nearly 21 times since the Islamic Revolution -which exhibits the key value of equity, fairness and inclusiveness.

56. 4.3 Has a framework of open science competencies been incorporated into higher education research skills curricula in your country, or is it foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (iv) 19.b)

☐ Yes

☒ No

57. 4.3 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

No. but it is under consideration. And there is a plan to move towards creating such a framework in the current year.

58. 4.4 Are open educational resources[i] as defined in the 2019 Recommendation on Open Educational Resources, used as an instrument for open science capacity building in your country in line with the 2019 Recommendation mentioned above? (ref.: (iv) 19.d)

[i] Open Educational Resources are learning, teaching and research materials in any format and medium that reside in the public domain or are under copyright that have been released under an open license, that permit no-cost access, re-use, re-purpose, adaptation and redistribution by others (2019 Recommendation on Open Educational Resources)

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Partly
- ☒ No

59. 4.5 Have there been any initiatives in your country to support science communication in line with open science value and principles with a view to the dissemination of scientific knowledge to researchers of different disciplines, decision-makers and the public at large? (ref.: (iv) 19.e)

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

60. 4.5 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant.

Promotion of Scientific approach and dissemination of scientific knowledge is taught and researched in some departments of the universities and research institutes, including one in the National Research on Science Policy which is the home of UNESCO CHAIR See <https://en.nrisp.ac.ir/about-unesco-cps/>

Part 5. FOSTERING A CULTURE OF OPEN SCIENCE AND ALIGNING INCENTIVES FOR OPEN SCIENCE

61. 5.1 Have there been any initiatives at the national or institutional level, e.g. by universities and/or research performing institutions, to review the existing research assessment and evaluation processes in order to align them with open science principles and values or are they foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.b, 20c, 20i)

☒ Yes

☐ No

62. 5.1 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant.

Yes, such initiatives are being discussed and plans are being drawn to be implemented towards the end of 2025.

63. 5.2 Have specific clauses that recognize open science practices, including sharing, collaborating and engaging with other researchers and societal actors beyond the scientific community, or dialogue with other knowledge systems, been incorporated in the career evaluation and progression systems or are foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.a, 20.c, 20.d)

☒ Yes

☐ No

64. 5.2 cont. **If yes**, please provide details and links as relevant.

There are plans under consideration to do so by the end 2025.

65. 5.3 Have there been any initiatives in your country to recognize and reward open science practices or are they foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.a, 20.b, 20.c, 20.e, 20.f, 20.g, 20h)

☒ Yes

☐ No

66. 5.3 cont. **If yes**, for each initiative, please provide more information, including on the stakeholders[i] that are involved or lead the initiative, and links as relevant.

[i] For example, research funders, universities, research institutions, learned societies, scientific publishers and journal editorial boards.

Yes! There are plans and it is foreseen to implement them by the end of 2025.

67. 5.4 Have there been any unintended negative consequences[i] of open science practices reported in your country? (ref.: (v) 20)

[i] For example, predatory behaviours, data migration, exploitation and privatization of research data, increased costs for scientists and high article processing charges associated with certain business models in scientific publishing that may be causes of inequality for the scientific communities around the world and, in some cases, the loss of intellectual property and knowledge.

☐ Yes

☒ No

Part 6. PROMOTING INNOVATIVE APPROACHES FOR OPEN SCIENCE AT DIFFERENT STAGES OF THE SCIENTIFIC PROCESS

68. 6.1 Have there been any initiatives at the national or institutional level that promote innovative, participatory methodological or procedural changes at different stages of the research cycle to increase the openness of the entire scientific process? (ref.: (vi) 21)

- ☐ YES, at the national level
- ☐ YES, at the institutional level
- ☒ YES, at both the national and institutional levels
- ☐ No

69. 6.1 cont. **If yes**, please indicate which of the recommended actions they address:

- ☐ promotion of pre-prints
- ☐ exploration of open peer-review practices
- ☐ valuing and sharing of negative scientific results and associated data
- ☐ participatory methods that value inputs from societal actors, e.g. citizen science, crowdsourcing scientific projects
- ☒ development of participatory strategies for identifying the needs of marginalized communities and highlighting socially relevant issues to be incorporated into research agendas
- ☐ promoting open innovation practices
- ☒ Yes, at the national level, by Promoting social innovation for marginalized people. See for ex

70. 6.1. cont. **If yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant

https://www.researchgate.net/publication/351322744_Social_innovation_participatory_action_research_for_empowerment_of_marginalized_people

Part 7. PROMOTING INTERNATIONAL AND MULTI-STAKEHOLDER COOPERATION IN THE CONTEXT

OF OPEN SCIENCE AND WITH VIEW TO REDUCING DIGITAL, TECHNOLOGICAL AND KNOWLEDGE GAPS

71. 7.1 How is your country promoting and facilitating international scientific collaborations on open science as outlined in the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science? (ref.: (vii) 22.a)

Yes! Iran has planned to invite the Islamic countries, building a region of science roads without borders through implementing regional open science policy. the OIC is the most appropriate intergovernmental body to build a regional open source community. The relevant link will be provided as soon as possible.

72. 7.2 Does your country have a strategy or a plan for stimulating cross-border multi-stakeholder collaboration on open science, including with regards to exchange of best practices, capacity building and metrics for open science? (ref.: (vii) 22.b, 22.e, 22.f)

☒ Yes

☐ No

73. 7.2 cont. **If yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information.

See the response provided to question no. 7.1

74. 7.3 Is your country involved in any discussion on the establishment of regional and international funding mechanisms for open science? (ref.: (vii) 22.c)

☒ Yes

☐ No

75. 7.3 cont. **If yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information.

Yes! the allocation of resources is under consideration by the relevant authorities.

Part 8. GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

76. 8.1 Are there any specific external causes that may impede the implementation of the 2021 UNESCO Recommendation on Open Science in your country?

☒ Yes

☐ No

77. 8.1 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information.

sanctions

78. ANY OTHER COMMENTS: If you wish, you may enter any additional comments or information here. You may also contact openscience@unesco.org